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Helmet with slippage pads

Abstract

There is provided a helmet with at least an inner liner forming a body of the helmet, the inner liner having a concave inner surface defining a cavity configured for receiving a wearer's head. The helmet has a plurality of slippage pads disposed at selected locations on the concave inner surface and connected to the inner liner. The slippage pads have an elongated shape with its length greater than its width. Each slippage pad defines a number of integrally connected side-by-side tubes each having an opening adapted to be oriented toward the wearer's head. The openings are aligned longitudinally along the length of the slippage pads. The helmet also has an attachment system to attach the helmet to the wearer's head.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present application is related to and claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Patent Application Nos. 62/626,913, filed on Feb. 6, 2018, 62/657,157, filed on Apr. 13, 2018, 62/782,022, filed on Dec. 19, 2018, and 62/794,189, filed on Jan. 18, 2019, the entire content of each of which said applications is incorporated herein by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present application relates to sport helmets, such as bicycle helmets.

BACKGROUND OF THE ART

(2) Bicycle helmets have now become ubiquitous for the bicycling activity, and other sports. In road and urban bicycle riding, one specific helmet construction is commonly used: that consisting of the foam inner liner with an outer shell. The inner liner forms the body of the helmet in terms of volume and structural integrity. The inner liner is typically made of a structural foam material such as expanded polystyrene. An outer shell covers the liner and defines the smooth, aerodynamic and/or decorative exposed outer surface of the helmet. The outer shell and liner are most often co-molded, and additional structural and attachment components. Other components include the attachment system inside the outer shell, by which the helmet is secured to the user's head. The above-referred configuration is quite convenient in terms of providing suitable head protection, while being lightweight.

(3) However, while protecting the head from some form of traumatic injuries such as skull fractures

and skin wounds, helmets may leave the wearer exposed to some other forms of trauma, such as concussions. For example, angled impacts on one's head may result in a concussion, in spite of the presence of a helmet. Accordingly, some technologies have been developed to assist in absorbing shocks, such as that described in U.S. Pat. No. 8,578,520. It describes the presence of an attachment device that accommodates the wearer's head. The attachment device is a low-friction layer that creates a relative motion between the inner liner and the skull, at a point of angled contact. Hence, rotational energy is directed away from the brain, so as to reduce the strain in the brain tissue at an impact.

SUMMARY

(4) Therefore, it is an aim of the present disclosure to provide a helmet that addresses issues associated with the prior art.

(5) In accordance with an aspect, there is provided a helmet comprising: at least an inner liner forming a body of the helmet, the inner liner having a concave inner surface defining a cavity configured for receiving a wearer's head; a plurality of slippage pads disposed at selected locations on the concave inner surface and connected to the inner liner, the slippage pads having an elongated shape with a length and a width, the length being greater than the width, the slippage pads each defining a number of integrally connected side-by-side tubes each having an opening adapted to be oriented toward the wearer's head, the openings aligned longitudinally along the length of the slippage pads and an attachment system to attach the helmet to the wearer's head.

(6) Further in accordance with this aspect all the slippage pads are, for instance, shaped and size to be identical to each other.

(7) Still further in accordance with this aspect, lateral pairs of the slippage pads are, for instance, disposed on each side of a sagittal plane of the helmet.

(8) Still further in accordance with this aspect, the lateral pairs of the slippage pads are, for instance, evenly laterally spaced apart from the sagittal plane of the helmet.

(9) Still further in accordance with this aspect, a frontal pair of the slippage pads is, for instance, disposed in a frontal portion of the helmet.

(10) Still further in accordance with this aspect, the helmet further comprises, for instance, at least one cushioning pad disposed on the concave inner surface of the inner liner.

(11) Still further in accordance with this aspect, the cushioning pad has apertures defined therethrough, for instance, the apertures corresponding in shape and dimensions to the slippage pads, for instance, some of the slippage pads are disposed within the apertures of the cushioning pad.

(12) Still further in accordance with this aspect, the cushioning pad and the slippage pads disposed within the apertures form, for instance, a continuous surface adapted to be oriented toward the wearer's head.

(13) Still further in accordance with this aspect, recesses are defined within the inner liner, for instance, the slippage pads have a base portion received in respective ones of the recesses, the slippage pads having a head contacting portion projecting beyond a surrounding surface of the inner liner, for instance.

(14) Still further in accordance with this aspect, the recesses and the slippage pads are, for instance, dimensioned for lateral walls of the slippage pads to contact surfaces of the recesses.

(15) Still further in accordance with this aspect, a peripheral space is defined between lateral walls of the recesses and a periphery of the slippage pads, for instance, to allow the slippage pads to expand laterally while being compressed until the periphery of the slippage pads abuts against the lateral walls of the recesses.

(16) Still further in accordance with this aspect, a ratio of a recess depth over a thickness of the slippage pads is between 1:2 and 1:4, for instance.

(17) Still further in accordance with this aspect, the slippage pads have a length of $40\text{ mm} \pm 20\text{ mm}$, and a width of $13\text{ mm} \pm 7\text{ mm}$, for instance.

- (18) Still further in accordance with this aspect, a thickness of the slippage pads ranges between 2 mm and 10 mm, for instance.
- (19) Still further in accordance with this aspect, a density of the slippage pads is $0.27 \text{ g/cm}^3 \pm 0.10 \text{ g/cm}^3$, for instance.
- (20) Still further in accordance with this aspect, the slippage pads are made of, for instance, a composite material including polyurethane and a non-Newtonian polymeric material.
- (21) Still further in accordance with this aspect, the slippage pads are each formed as an integral monolithic piece of a non-Newtonian polymeric material, for instance.
- (22) Still further in accordance with this aspect, the plurality of tubes is a pair of tubes, for instance, the openings of the pair of tubes each having an obround shape, for instance.
- (23) Still further in accordance with this aspect, the openings have a length of $15 \text{ mm} \pm 5 \text{ mm}$ and a width of $5 \text{ mm} \pm 3 \text{ mm}$, for instance.
- (24) Still further in accordance with this aspect, a ratio of the sum of a length of the openings over the length of the slippage pad is $70\% \pm 20\%$, for instance.
- (25) Still further in accordance with this aspect, a ratio of a width of the openings over the width of the slippage pad range between 25% and 40%, for instance.
- (26) Still further in accordance with this aspect, at least a first and a second one of the slippage pads are longitudinally oriented in a front-to-rear direction of the helmet, for instance, the at least two slippage pads having a respective longitudinal projection extending between the opposite lateral portions of the helmet.
- (27) Still further in accordance with this aspect, the inner liner is made of, for instance, expanded polystyrene.
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Description

DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a helmet with a slip plane system in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (2) FIG. 2 is a schematic view of an inner cavity of the helmet of FIG. 1 showing a distribution of the slippage pads;
- (3) FIG. 3 is a perspective view of a slippage pad as used in FIG. 2;
- (4) FIG. 4 is a sectional schematic view of one of the slippage pads between a pair of cushioning pads;
- (5) FIG. 5 is a schematic elevation view of embodiments of bristles of the slippage pads;
- (6) FIGS. 6A-6B are schematic views of one of the slippage pads between a pair of cushioning pads, in accordance with another embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (7) FIG. 7 is a top view of a slippage pad as used in FIG. 2, in accordance with another embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (8) FIG. 8 is an elevation view of the slippage pad of FIG. 1;
- (9) FIG. 9 is a top view of a cluster of slippage pads shown in FIGS. 7-8;
- (10) FIG. 10 is a perspective view of a slippage pad as used in FIG. 2, in accordance with another embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (11) FIG. 11 is a top view of the slippage pad of FIG. 10;
- (12) FIG. 12 is an elevation view of the slippage pad of FIG. 10;
- (13) FIG. 13 is a schematic view of an inner cavity of the helmet of FIG. 1 showing a distribution of the slippage pads, in accordance with another embodiment;
- (14) FIG. 14 is a perspective view of a slippage pad as used in FIG. 13, in accordance with another embodiment;
- (15) FIG. 15 is a sectional elevation view of a slippage pad as used in FIG. 13, in accordance with

another embodiment; and

(16) FIGS. **16-23** are perspective views of embodiments of slippage pads as used in FIG. **13**;

(17) FIG. **24** is a sectional elevation view of a slippage pad as used in FIG. **13**, in accordance with another embodiment;

(18) FIG. **25** is a perspective view of an inner cavity of the helmet of FIG. **1** showing a distribution of the slippage pads, in accordance with some embodiments; and

(19) FIG. **26** is a cross-sectional view of a portion of the helmet of FIG. **1**, taken along the plane **26-26** of FIG. **25**.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(20) Referring to the drawings, and more particularly to FIG. **1**, there is illustrated a helmet **10** in accordance with the present disclosure. The helmet **10** is of the type that is used for bicycling and like sporting activities.

(21) For simplicity, an attachment system is only summarily shown as **11**. The attachment system is typically anchored to an interior of the helmet and features straps for the helmet to be strapped to the user's head. The attachment system may also comprise rigid attachment components in the rear of the helmet, to adjust the helmet to a circumference of the wearer's head. Hence, although summarily shown, the helmet **10** has such attachment means of any appropriate form.

(22) The helmet **10** has a generally hemispherical shape formed by an inner liner **12** and an outer shell **13**. By its hemispherical shape, the helmet **10** has an inner concave surface and outer convex surface, with the top and side of the wearer's head being received in the inner concavity.

(23) The inner liner **12** is typically made of foam (e.g., expanded polystyrene or the like) and constitutes the major component of the helmet **10** in terms of volume and energy absorption capability: it is the structure of the helmet **10**. Moreover, the foam is of the type being generally rigid and hence providing the structural integrity to the helmet **10**, in terms of maintaining its shape. In other words, the foam liner is not of the resilient type that is supported by a rigid shell, but rather of the type that is the main structural component of the helmet **10**. It is by the combination of the attachment system **11** and the inner liner **12** that the helmet **10** remains attached to the wearer's head. The inner liner **12** covers an upper portion of the head, and the attachment system **11** prevents the inner liner **12** from being pulled off (in translation). However, some play may be present between the head of the wearer and the inner liner **12**, due to the somewhat complementary spherical shapes. The play is used for assisting in absorbing angled impacts on the helmet.

(24) The outer shell **13** is integrally connected to the inner liner **12** and forms the major portion of the exposed convex surface of the helmet **10**. The integral connection may be achieved by way of adhesives or co-molding (i.e., molding of the inner liner **12** with the outer shell **13** positioned in the mold cavity beforehand). The outer shell **13** is made of a plastic layer, such as polycarbonate or the like. The outer shell **13** defines the smooth and decorative outer surface of the helmet **10**. Other components may be present, such as a cage, as described in U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/049,375, the contents of which are incorporated herein by reference. Also, the helmet **10** may have an inner liner **12**, but no outer shell **13**, or multiple shell segments, among other possible variants.

(25) Referring to FIG. **2**, an interior of the helmet **10** is shown, with the attachment system **11** removed for simplicity. Vents **14** are shown as being defined at least partially by the inner liner **12**, and allow air circulation in and out of the helmet **10**. Cushioning pads **15** may be distributed at various locations in the interior of the helmet **10**. A plurality of slippage pads **20** are distributed in the inner cavity of the helmet **10**. The cushioning pads **15** and the slippage pads **20** are padding interfaces between a surface of the inner cavity of the inner liner **12** and the wearer's head. The cushioning pads **15** and slippage pads **20** serve no function of attachment of the helmet **10** to the wearer's head. The cushioning pads **15** and slippage pads **20** provide cushioning to make the helmet **10** more comfortable, and may hence reduce some of the play between the inner liner **12** and the

wearer's head. The cushioning pads **15** and the slippage pads **20** may also perform some management of the linear and rotational forces and movement that occur upon impact on the helmet **10**.

(26) Moreover, the slippage pads **20** may allow a relative slippage motion between the surface of the inner liner **12** and the head of the wearer, in quasi-translational manner. As the surface of the inner liner **12** is concave, it is not fully flat. Hence, the movement depicted by the arrows is not purely translational, but close to a translation, explaining the use of the expression quasi-translational, as well as the expression slip plane system, as non-flat planes of the inner liner **12** and of the skull of the wearer may move relative to one another. The movement may also be described as a sliding movement of a part of the slippage pads **20** relative to the concave surface of the inner liner **12**. It is the resistance of this sliding movement that allows absorption of angled impacts on the helmet **10**.

(27) Referring to FIG. 3, an embodiment of the slippage pad **20** is shown. The slippage pad **20** has a base **30** and a plurality of bristles **40** projecting from the base **30**. In an embodiment, the base **30** and bristles **40** are a monoblock piece made of a single material, although it is contemplated to assemble the base **30** and bristles **40** from separate components, such as in a brush. The base **30** is the interface of the slippage pad **20** with the inner liner **12** of the helmet, i.e., the component by which the slippage pad **20** is secured to the foam of the inner liner **12**, or other structural component if the helmet **10** does not have a foam inner liner **12**. For example, the base **30** may be glued, fused, etc to the liner **12**. Some attachment means may also be provided, such as an adhesive, complementary strips of patches of hooks and loops, for example. The base **30** may also be comolded with the inner liner **12**, or may be inserted after the molding of the inner liner **12**. The base **30** may be a resilient pad (e.g., gel pad, foam pad, fluid in a membrane). Other configurations are possible as well.

(28) The base **30** may have any appropriate shape, such as a disk, square, obround, etc. For example, as in FIG. 3, the base **30** may have an elongated shape, such as an elongated hexagon, as one possible embodiment, or even an elongated strip that extends a substantial portion of the longitudinal direction of the helmet **10**, as shown in FIG. 2. The undersurface **31** of the base **30** may be generally planar or may conform to the shape of the surface of the inner liner **12**. In an embodiment, such as in FIG. 3, the bristles **40** are normal to a plane of the base **30**, i.e., taking into consideration that the base **30** may not be flat. Assuming that the base **30** when installed has local curvatures, the bristles **40** are radially oriented relative to local curvatures of the base **30**.

(29) The bristles **40** are the slippage components, and may have other names, such as upstanding or elongated members, hairs, filaments, posts, etc. Referring to FIGS. 5A to 5D, the bristles **40** may be shown as having three portions, namely a connection end portion **40A** by which the bristles **40** are connected to the base **30**, an elongated body portion **40B**, and a free end portion **40C**. FIGS. 5A to 5D illustrates non-exhaustively various possible shapes for the bristles **40**, such as with a larger connection end portion **40A**, a global taper, or a straight body, and even with an enlarged free end portion **40C**. The bristles **40** are relatively density distributed on the base **30**, so as to form a brush-like configuration. The bristles **40** may therefore move in multiple directions, which can be generally described as having the free end portions **40C** move along an imaginary sphere surface trajectory. The bristles **40** may also buckle as a result of compressive forces, in such a way that the free end portions **40C** move toward the base **30**, such that the slippage pads **20** may also provide cushioning.

(30) The preceding figures show the slippage pads **20** with the bristles **40** defining the exposed surface. It is optionally considered to provide a membrane on top of the bristles **40** so as to separate a user's head from direct contact with the tips of the bristles **40**. Referring to FIG. 6, there is shown such a membrane at **50**, the membrane **50** may be used with any appropriate configuration of the bristles, for instance the bristles of FIG. 5A to 5D. In accordance with an embodiment, the membrane **50** is a non-rigid fabric or light material, figures such as polyester, nylon, cotton,

polymers. The membrane **50** may simply be laid upon the tips of the bristles with any appropriate connection between the base **30**, the bristles **40** and/or the membrane **50**. For example, the membrane may fully encapsulate the bristles **40** by being connected at its extremities to the base **30**. As another example, the membrane **50** may be secured to peripheral bristles. As yet another example, the base **30** may define a wall **51** projecting upwardly in the same direction as the bristles **40**, but not all the way to the tip of the bristles, with the membrane **50** connected to it. As yet another example, the membrane **50** is a pocket in which the base **30** and the bristles **40** are encapsulated. Such a slippage pad **20** would have for example Velcro™ or like connection means to be secured to the helmet **10**.

(31) The material of the bristles **40**, and of the base **30** when the base **30** and the bristles **40** form a monoblock piece of a single material, is selected to be compliant and have flexibility, i.e., be capable of movements in the elastic deformation range, to then regain the shape of FIG. 2. For example, materials such as moldable rubbery polymers are well suited for being used as material of the slippage pads **20**. Materials include silicone, polyethylene, polypropylene, and natural materials such as rubber. According to an embodiment, the slippage pad **20** is an integrally monolithic piece, such as a molded unitary piece. A composite slippage pad **20** may also be formed. Accordingly, the bristles **40** have the capacity of elastically returning to their initial unloaded shapes, for “lateral” movements of the free end portions **40C** (i.e., an imaginary sphere surface trajectory), and for distorting, flexing, shearing and/or buckling.

(32) In terms of dimensions, the length of the bristles **40** may range from 1.0 mm to 7.0 mm in an embodiment, although it is contemplated to have longer bristles **40** as well. The thickness of the base **30** may range from 0.3 mm to 3.0 mm, although it is contemplated to have a thicker base **30** as well. In an embodiment, as shown in FIG. 4, the slippage pads **20** are thinner than the cushioning pads **15** in a rest condition of the pads **15**. However, it is also contemplated to have the pads **20** thicker than the pads **15**. However, the bristles **40** may have a slightly greater rigidity than the cushioning pads **15** such that the pads **15** collapse when a load is applied, for the bristles **40** to oppose their rigidity against loads. Slippage pads **20** may therefore be located between cushioning pads **15**, for the cushioning pads **15** to form the leading interface surface of the helmet **10** with the wearer's head. The slippage pads **20** may also be used on their own, as in FIG. 2.

(33) Due to the cushioning and the deformation, the bristles **40** may provide a non-negligible level of friction with the wearer's head (skin and/or hair, or cap or fabric), such that an angled impact on the helmet **10** will result in deformation of the bristles **40** relative to the wearer's head. In other words, an angled impact on the helmet **10** may result in a movement resulting from deformation of the bristles **40** and relative movement of free ends of the bristles **40** relative to the inner liner **12**. An embodiment with the enlarged free end portion **40C** may assist in ensuring suitable friction between the wearer's head and the bristles **40**. A high enough density of bristles **40** per surface unit of the base **30** may also assist.

(34) Therefore, when an angled impact is made on the helmet **10**, the slippage pads **20**, in contact with various discrete locations of the wearer's head, will allow displacement of the inner liner **12** relative to the wearer's head, by deformation of the bristles **40**, while the bases **30** generally remain at the discrete locations on the helmet. This displacement of the inner liner **12** relative to the wearer's head will lessen the rotational velocity movement on the wearer's head. The slippage pads **20** are independent from one another, as they are not concurrently related to an attachment device. In other words, each slippage pad **20** will enable local deformation independently of how the other slippage pads **20** react. As mentioned previously, the deformation may be in the form of flexion and/or buckling of the bristles **40**.

(35) Referring to FIGS. 7 and 8, another slippage pad is shown, at **20**. The slippage pad **20** of FIGS. 7 and 8 may or may not have a base **30**, by which an undersurface **31** of the slippage pad **20** may be attached to a helmet, in the manners described above. In this embodiment, a plurality of side-by-side tubes **70** form the body of the slippage pad **20**. As in FIG. 7, the tubes **70** may have an

hexagonal cross-section, with adjacent tubes **70** sharing walls to form a honey-comb style structure, i.e. with an opening **71** facing the head of the wearer. Central tube axes are generally parallel to one another and normal to a main plane of the slippage pad **20**, though the plane may not be flat during use. All central axes are oriented toward the wearer. However, other cross-sectional shapes for the tubes **70** are contemplated as well, including square, circular, triangular, diamond, etc. In FIGS. **7** and **8**, it is observed that there are no interstitial spaces between the tubes **70**, as adjacent tubes **70** have walls in common. Such interstitial spaces could trap hair, which could cause discomfort for the wearer of the helmet **10**. As another way to consider the pad **20** of FIGS. **7** and **8**, it may be regarded as block of a resilient material, in which an array of holes with opening(s) **71** are made in its main surface(s). In an embodiment where the base **30** is present, the openings **71** may extend through the base **30**. However, in some embodiments, the openings **71** may not extend all the way through the slippage pad **20** and/or the base **30** of the pad **20**.

(36) The dimensions of the slippage pad **20** may be any appropriate dimension for use in a helmet **10**. In an embodiment, the pads have an elongated shape with a length of $4.0\text{ cm} \pm 2.0\text{ cm}$, and a width of $1.3\text{ cm} \pm 0.5\text{ cm}$. However, the elongated shape is not necessary. The slippage pad **20** may have any other shape or configuration, with the dimensions ranging between 0.8 cm and 20.0 cm, though they may even be larger. As shown in FIG. **8**, the thickness may be of $0.5\text{ cm} + 1.0\text{ cm} - 0.2\text{ cm}$. This may or may not include the base **30**. In an embodiment, the base **30** has a 1 mm thickness. A widest dimension of the tubes **70** (e.g., from diametrically opposed apex, may be $4.0\text{ mm} \pm 1.0\text{ mm}$, although it may be more or less than that.

(37) The slippage pad **20** of FIGS. **7** and **8** may be integrally molded into a resilient elastomer. The material of the tubes **70**, and of the base **30** when the base **30** and the tubes **70** form a monoblock piece of a single material, is selected to be compliant and have flexibility, i.e., be capable of movements in the elastic deformation range, to then regain the shape of FIG. **2**. For example, materials such as moldable rubbery polymers are well suited for being used as material of the slippage pads **20**. Materials include silicone, polyethylene, polypropylene, TPU and natural materials such as rubber. The slippage pad **20** may also be made of a non-Newtonian polymer, in a gel or fluid form, for instance. In a particular embodiment, the slippage pad **20** is made of the non-Newtonian polymer known as DCLAN™ gel commercialized by Dongguan DCLAN Technology Co., Ltd. Such non-Newtonian polymer may harden from a non-rigid state (i.e. a gel state) to form an impact protection layer while absorbing, at least partially, the impact energy. This may occur when hydrogen bonds between molecules of the DCLAN gel temporarily break (e.g. break or separate), whereby the impact energy may dissipate.

(38) According to an embodiment with the tubes **70**, the slippage pad **20** is an integrally monolithic piece, such as a molded unitary piece. The slippage pad **20** may be manufactured using any suitable manufacturing technique. In one particularly embodiment, the slippage pad **20** is formed using additive manufacturing technique, such as 3D printing. In another particular embodiment, the slippage pad **20** is formed using injection molding. As shown in FIG. **9**, the slippage pad **20**, when formed by injection molding, though other manufacturing techniques may provide similar results, may be molded as a cluster of slippage pads **20** separated from one another, but interconnected in between them via a web **80** connected to the slippage pads **20**. In other words, the web **80** and the slippage pads **20** form an integrally monolithic piece, such as a molded unitary piece. That is, the web **80** and the discrete slippage pads **20** are formed, in such embodiment, as a single cluster of slippage pads **20** interconnected to one another and integrally molded as a monolithic piece. The web **80** and the slippage pads **20** are made of the same material, although a composite web **80** and slippage pads **20** assembly may also be formed of different materials.

(39) Having a cluster of slippage pads **20** interconnected to one another may allow easier and/or more convenient handling of the slippage pads **20** during the manufacturing and/or packaging steps, for instance. Each slippage pad **20** of the cluster may then be manually separated, or mechanically separated, for instance, from said cluster for individually installing/positioning them

in a helmet **10**, or for passing through one or more additional manufacturing steps. Although the slippage pads **20** shown in FIG. **9** are of the type shown in FIGS. **7** and **8**, the slippage pads **20** may take the form of any contemplated slippage pads **20**.

(40) In some cases, the web **80** and the slippage pads **20** may be directly installed in a helmet **10**, as a single slippage pad **20** assembly. For instance, the web **80** and the slippage pads **20** shown in FIG. **9** may be secured to the inner liner **12** of the helmet **10**, as discussed above with respect to other embodiments. More particularly, in an embodiment, the web **80** and the slippage pads **20**, are secured to the inner liner **12** such that the web **80** extends along a substantial portion of the longitudinal direction of the helmet **10**, and where the slippage pads **20** are distributed on opposite sides of the web **80** and positioned in the helmet **10** to overlay the opposite temporal portions of the wearer's head. In other words, in this configuration, the slippage pads **20** are distributed on opposite sides of a longitudinal central axis of the helmet **10**. In such an embodiment, the web **80** and the slippage pads **20** may be secured to the inner liner **12** using known connection means such as discussed earlier above. For instance, where the web **80** and the slippage pads **20** are removably connected to the inner liner **12**, by Velcro™ or otherwise, the web **80** with the slippage pads **20** may be purchased and installed in helmets not initially designed with such energy absorption features, such as is the case for conventional bicycle helmets. This may be done, for instance, to customize the helmet, or to retrofit helmets with such energy absorption features.

(41) A composite slippage pad **20** may also be formed. Accordingly, the tubes **70** have the capacity of elastically returning to their initial unloaded shapes, for “lateral” movements of the free end portions of the tubes **70** (i.e., those away from the helmet connection), and for buckling.

(42) Due to the cushioning and the deformation, the tubes **70** may provide a non-negligible level of friction with the wearer's head (skin and/or hair, or cap or fabric), such that an angled impact on the helmet **10** will result in geometrical deformation of the tubes **70** relative to the wearer's head. In other words, an angled impact on the helmet **10** may result in a movement resulting from deformation of the tubes **70** and relative movement of free ends of the tubes **70** relative to the inner liner **12**. The web of interconnected tubes **70** forms a planar surface (though pierced), ensuring suitable friction between the wearer's head and the tubes **70**. A high enough density of tubes **70** per surface unit of the base **30** may also assist.

(43) Therefore, when an angled impact is made on the helmet **10**, the slippage pads **20**, in contact with various discrete locations of the wearer's head, will allow displacement of the inner liner **12** relative to the wearer's head, by deformation of the tubes **70**, while the slippage pads **20** (e.g., via bases **30**) generally remain at the discrete locations on the helmet. This displacement of the inner liner **12** relative to the wearer's head will lessen the rotational velocity movement on the wearer's head. The slippage pads **20** are independent from one another, as they are not concurrently related to an attachment device. In other words, each slippage pad **20** will enable local deformation independently of how the other slippage pads **20** react. As mentioned previously, the deformation may be in the form of flexion, distortion, shearing and/or buckling of the tubes **70**.

(44) Referring to FIGS. **10** to **12**, another slippage pad **20** is shown, in accordance with another embodiment of the present disclosure. The slippage pad **20** shown in FIGS. **10** to **12** may share structural and functional similarities with the embodiments discussed above and below. As shown, and similar to the embodiment shown in FIGS. **7** and **8**, the slippage pad **20** forms a series of tubes **70**, interconnected to each other by a common wall **72**. As shown, the slippage pad **20** has a pair of tubes **70** with their respective openings **71** made on their respective head contacting surface for being oriented towards the wearer's head when provided in the helmet **10** and when the helmet **10** is worn. The slippage pad **20** of FIGS. **10** to **12** has a generally rectangular outline, but other shapes are considered, such as oval. Stated differently, the slippage pad **20** has a sequence of openings **71**, in this case obround holes (though other shapes are contemplated, including rectangular, with or without rounded corners), defined therethrough, opened toward the wearer's head. The openings **71** may have the same size, or a different size. The openings **71** are spaced apart from each other by

the common wall **72** in between them. In an embodiment, such as shown, the slippage pad **20** has two openings **71** adjacent to each other. In an embodiment, the slippage pad **20** has a single row of openings **71**. In other words, in an embodiment, the openings **71** are aligned in a single row extending along the length of the pad **20**, shown as being along axis X). The openings **71** may have an elongated shape with a length of $15\text{ mm}\pm 5\text{ mm}$ and a width of $5\text{ mm}\pm 3\text{ mm}$. In the embodiment shown, the common wall **72** between the adjacent openings **71** has a minimum longitudinal dimension (dimension taken along the length of the pad **20**, shown as being along axis X) of $4\text{ mm}\pm 2\text{ mm}$. In an embodiment, the minimum longitudinal dimension of the common wall **72** is between 10% to 20%, inclusively of the length of the slippage pad **20** of FIGS. **10-12**. Other dimensions may be contemplated for the openings **71** in other embodiments. The expression “minimum longitudinal dimension” is used considering that the wall **72** may not have a constant dimension, notably if the openings **71** are obround.

(45) There may be more than two openings **71** per slippage pad **20** in other embodiments. The openings **71** may be evenly distributed in said slippage pad **20**, although this may be different in other embodiments (non even distribution). The dimensions of the openings **71** may be defined as a ratio of their dimensions with a corresponding dimensions of the slippage pad **20**. For instance, in an embodiment, a ratio of the sum of the length of the openings **71** over the length of the slippage pad **20** is $70\%\pm 20\%$. A ratio of the width of the openings **71** over the width of the slippage pad **20** may range between 25% and 40% —the width being along axis Y. Other ratios may be contemplated in other embodiments. As shown in FIG. **12**, the slippage pad **20** may optionally have a base **30**, with its undersurface **31**, as discussed above with respect to other embodiments. Stated differently, the openings **71** may be through openings, i.e., open on opposed sides of the slippage pad **20** of FIGS. **10-12**, but it is also contemplated to have the tubes **70** in a close-ended configuration, i.e., one end being closed, by way of the base **30**. For example, the closed end could be the one against the inner liner **12**, as this closed end could increase the bonding surface of the slippage pad **20** with the inner liner **12**. The slippage pad **20** may be disposed at selected locations on the inner liner **12** of the helmet **10**, as discussed above and shown in FIG. **2**. Also, such slippage pad **20** may be combined with cushioning pads **15** distributed in the inner cavity of the helmet **10**, in an alternating sequence of slippage pads **20** and cushioning pads **15**, or otherwise, for instance. According to an embodiment, the slippage pad **20** of FIGS. **10-12** is monoblock. The base **30**, if present, may or may not be part of the monoblock.

(46) Referring to FIG. **13**, there is shown a schematic view of an inner cavity of the helmet **10** according to another embodiment. The helmet has the outer shell **13**, inner liner **12**, and cushioning pad(s) **15**, similar to that discussed above. As shown, slippage pads **20** are distributed in the inner cavity of the helmet **10**, such as to individually face discrete portions of the wearer's head when the helmet **10** is worn. The slippage pads **20** may have different shapes, such as the ones described later.

(47) FIGS. **14** and **15** show how the slippage pads **20** may be mounted into the helmet **10**. More specifically, a bottom portion of the slippage pad **20** is received in a recess **16** defined within the inner liner **12** (inner liner **12** or cushioning pad **15** where the slippage pad **20** is directly mounted on the cushioning pad **15**). At least part of the bottom portion of the slippage pad **20** may be adhesively bonded to the inner liner **12** or cushioning pad **15**. For instance, the bonding zones B shown in FIGS. **14** and **15** are located at the bottommost portion of the slippage pad **20** only. This may allow the remainder of the bottom portion of the slippage pad **20**—i.e., one that is unattached to the inner liner **12**—just as the top portion of the slippage pad **20**, to deform “laterally”, stretch, buckle, distort, and/or shear when an angled impact (e.g. angled force or tangential force relative to a longitudinal axis of the slippage pad **20**) is made on the helmet **10**, even though the bottom portion is in the recess **16** and surrounded by inner liner **12** or cushioning pad **15** material. In other words, the peripheral surface of the bottom portion, where it is not adhesively bonded or physically attached to the liner **12**, may move toward and away from the recess **16** wall when the slippage pad

20 deforms. Other ways for securing the slippage pads **20** to the inner liner **12** or cushioning pad **15** may also be contemplated, such as mechanical interlock due to interlocking shapes of the slippage pads **20** and the recess **16**, for instance.

(48) Also, as shown, the slippage pads **20** may or may not have an opening **71** extending all the way through the length of the slippage pad **20**. In the embodiment shown in FIG. **15**, the slippage pad **20** defines a tube **70** that extends through the full length of the slippage pad **20**.

(49) In operation, when an angled impact is made on the helmet **10**, the slippage pads **20**, in contact with various discrete locations of the wearer's head, allow displacement of the inner liner **12** relative to the wearer's head, by deformation of the slippage pads **20**, while the slippage pads **20** remain bonded to the inner liner **12** or cushioning pad **15**, and the bottom portions of the slippage pads **20** remain in a respective recess **16**. While the slippage pads **20** are deforming, for instance “laterally”, the slippage pads **20** may compress to absorb energy from the angled impact. As they deform, a gap may be created between the recess wall and the peripheral surface of the bottom portion of the slippage pad **20**. Thus, at least part of the peripheral surface of the bottom portion moves away from the recess **16** wall while an opposite part of the peripheral surface of the bottom portion is compressed against the recess **16** wall as a result of the deformation of the slippage pad **20**. Although in the embodiments shown in FIGS. **14** and **15** the bottom portion of the slippage pad **20** has a size and shape corresponding to the shape and size of the recess **16** in which it is received, this may be different in other embodiments. For instance, the recess **16** may be larger than the bottom portion of the slippage pad **20**, such that only the bottommost portion of the slippage pad **20** that is secured to the inner liner **12** or cushioning pad **15** contacts the recess **16** wall, when the slippage pad **20** is in a non-deformed state. This may allow the bottom portion to expand laterally when the slippage pad **20** is compressed longitudinally, which may increase the amount of energy absorption due to angled impact, for instance. In other cases, the recess **16** may be smaller than the bottom portion of the slippage pad **20**, such that the bottom portion does not entirely recede within the recess **16**.

(50) Referring to FIGS. **16** to **24**, embodiments of the slippage pads **20** used in the helmet **10** shown in FIG. **13** are shown and vary in one or more structural characteristics, as discussed below.

(51) As shown in FIG. **16**, the slippage pad **20** may have a varying cross-section shape and/or a uniform cross-section with varying dimensions, along its length. More particularly, the slippage pad **20** may have a circular cross-section that decreases progressively towards an end of the slippage pad **20** and converges to form an apex (or pointed shape) at its end. The slippage pad **20** shown includes an opening **71** at its top end, such as discussed above with respect to other embodiments. In this embodiment, the opening **71** does not extend all the way through the length of the slippage pad **20** (i.e. a hole is formed on the top end of the slippage pad **20**, and such hole has a closed end). Also shown, the slippage pad **20** defines a shouldered portion **73** configured to abut against a corresponding surface of the inner liner **12** (inner liner **12** or cushioning pad **15** where the slippage pad **20** is directly mounted on the cushioning pad **15**). As such, when mounted in the helmet **10**, an upper portion of the slippage pad **20** protrudes from the concave inner surface of the inner liner **12** as the shouldered portion **73** abuts against the inner liner **12** or cushioning pad **15**.

(52) As shown in FIG. **17**, and similar to the embodiment shown in FIG. **16**, the slippage pad **20** has an opening **71** defined at a top end thereof. The slippage pad **20** has varying cross-sectional dimensions, and in this case a circular shape (though other cross-section shape is contemplated), which progressively decreases toward a bottom end of the slippage pad **20**. In another embodiment, the slippage pad **20** may have a constant cross-section along its length, such as shown in FIGS. **18**, **19** and **21**. In the embodiment shown in FIG. **18**, the slippage pad **20** has an opening **71** that does not go all the way through the length of the slippage pad **20**. This is different in FIG. **19**, where the opening **71** extends through the slippage pad **20** completely. Also, the example shown in FIG. **19** has an oblong shape.

(53) The embodiment of the slippage pad **20** shown in FIG. **20**, similar to the embodiment shown in FIG. **16**, has a shouldered portion **73** configured to abut against the concave inner surface of the inner liner **12** or cushioning pad **15**. As shown, the slippage pad **20** has an opening **71** such as discussed above with respect to other embodiments. The slippage pad **20** also has a generally cylindrical shape with a cross-section that varies along the length of the slippage pad **20**.

(54) In an embodiment, as shown in FIG. **21**, the slippage pad **20** has a generally circular shape, though other cross-sections, such as a honeycomb cross-section, are contemplated. In this embodiment, the slippage pad **20** includes a plurality of side-by-side tubes **70** forming the body of the slippage pad **20**. Similar to the embodiment shown in FIGS. **7** and **8**, the tubes **70** have an hexagonal cross-section, with adjacent tubes **70** sharing walls to form a honey-comb style structure, i.e. with openings **71** facing the head of the wearer. In this embodiment, when an angled impact is made on the helmet equipped with such slippage pads **20**, the walls between adjacent tubes **70** distort, buckle or otherwise deform to absorb impact energy.

(55) Referring to FIG. **22**, similar to the embodiment shown in FIG. **18**, the slippage pad **20** has a generally circular shape with a cross-section with constant (constant or substantially constant) dimensions along the length of the slippage pad **20**. The slippage pad **20** has an opening **71** defined at a top end thereof. The opening **71** does not go all the way through the length of the slippage pad **20**. This may help deflect, shear, compress or otherwise deform the slippage pad **20** and/or allow for a reduction of the weight of the slippage pad **20** compared to variants of the slippage pad **20** without opening **71**.

(56) As shown, the slippage pad **20** has slits **74** defined at an head-contacting end thereof. The slits **74** define a crown portion configured to contact the wearer's head. As shown, in this case, the slippage pad **20** has a pair of slits **74** extending from side to side of the pad **20** and transversally from each other. As such, the pair of slits **74** form four segments **75** in the end of the slippage pad **20**. In this case, the segments **75** are arcuate segments. Stated differently, the slits **74** may define a cruciform shape at the end of the slippage pad **20**. The segments **75** may each deform individually to distribute pressure and/or decrease pressure points on the head over slippage pad **20** with a flat end.

(57) Although four segments **75** are shown in FIG. **22**, there may be more or less segments **75** and/or slits **74** defined at the end of the slippage pad **20**. Additionally or alternately, the segments **75** may have different shape than the illustrated arcuate shape, depending on the cross-section shape and/or cross-section dimensions of the slippage pad **20**, for instance. The slits **74** and segments **75** may also be present in embodiments of the slippage pad **20** without opening **71**.

(58) In addition to or instead of the crown portion formed by the slits **74**, the slippage pad **20** may have a rounded top end. That is, the end of the slippage pad **20**, with or without the slits **74**, which is contactable with the wearer's head may have an hemispherical shape when viewed from a side elevational view. This is shown in FIG. **23**. Such rounded shape may improve comfort over a slippage pad **20** with a flat end, when in contact with the wearer's head.

(59) Referring to FIG. **24**, a slippage pad **20** secured to an inner liner **12** portion is depicted, according to another embodiment. The slippage pad **20** has a bottom portion secured in a recess **16** defined within the inner liner **12**. The slippage pad **20** has an upper portion that protrudes from the concave inner surface of the inner liner **12**, out from the recess **16**. The monikers "bottom" and "upper" are used because of the orientation of FIG. **24**. However, such monikers should be understood to mean the orientation of the slippage pad **20** when the helmet **10** is worn. In fact, the slippage pad **20** is often oriented upside down or sideways relative to the orientation of FIG. **24**, when the helmet is worn **10**. As shown, the slippage pad **20** has a constant cross-section shape that varies in dimensions along its length. The upper and bottom portions may have a circular cross-section shape, though the cross-section shape may be different between the bottom portion (e.g., square) and the upper portion (e.g., round). The upper portion has a smaller diameter than a diameter of the bottom portion. In other words, a cross-sectional area of the upper portion is

smaller than a cross-sectional area of the bottom portion (i.e. cross-sectional areas taken along a plane perpendicular to a longitudinal axis of the slippage pad **20**). In this case, similar to FIG. **23**, the top end of the upper portion of the slippage pad **20** has a rounded shape or rounded edges.

(60) For instance, in some cases, the cross-sectional area of the bottom portion is twice the cross-sectional area (i.e. cross-sectional area of the upper portion below the rounded edges of the top end, if present) of the upper portion, in some cases thrice the cross-sectional area of the upper portion, and in some cases the cross-sectional area of the bottom portion is even greater. This may apply also in embodiments where the cross-section shape(s) of either one or both of the upper and lower portions is not circular (e.g. polygonal cross-section shape, irregular cross-section shape, etc.).

(61) In some variants, the upper and bottom portions may have different cross-section shape, such that the upper portion may have a first cross-section shape and the bottom portion may have a second cross-section shape different from the first cross-section shape, though the upper and bottom portions may have the same cross-section shape and simply vary with respect to their respective dimensions. For instance, in some cases, the cross-section of the upper portion has a circular shape and the cross-section of the bottom portion has a polygonal shape. The respective cross-sections of the upper and bottom portions may be different in other cases.

(62) The upper portion defines a flexion zone and the bottom portion defines an impact energy absorption zone of the slippage pad **20**. The upper portion contacts the wearer's head when the helmet **10** is worn. The upper portion may adapt to the wearer's head shape due to its flexibility. Due to its relatively small cross-sectional area, the upper portion may flex, buckle, shear or otherwise deform while the helmet is donned and/or upon light loading (e.g. light impact load or simply a load exerted by the wearer's head when the helmet **10** is donned). The transverse rigidity of the upper portion being relatively low, the upper portion of the slippage pad **20** allows a relative slippage motion between the wearer's head and the inner surface of the inner liner **12**. This motion, in combination with the energy-absorbing characteristics of the slippage pad **20** may contribute to absorb energy from angled impacts made on the helmet **10** and transferred to the wearer's head. Also shown in FIG. **24**, the slippage pad **20** has an opening **71** that extends through the slippage pad **20**, thereby defining a tube **70** extending through the slippage pad **20**. Such hollowed configuration of the slippage pad **20** provides flexibility to the upper portion (less transverse rigidity) and/or reduce the weight of the slippage pad **20**. In some variants, the opening **71** may not extend through the slippage pad **20**, such that the opening **71** has a finite depth. Additionally or alternately, the slippage pad **20** may have more than one opening **71**, such as a series of side-by-side openings **71**.

(63) The bottom portion of the slippage pad **20** is contained and secured within the recess **16**. The bottom portion may be secured in the recess **16** by any suitable manner, such as adhesively bonding, co-molding, injection molding, inserting the bottom portion in friction or tight fit within the recess **16**, for instance. The bottom portion may absorb energy from angled impacts by deforming in compression and/or shear. The bottom portion is made of a viscoelastic material. In a particular embodiment, the viscoelastic material is a non-Newtonian polymer, such as the non-Newtonian polymer known as DCLAN gel. Other viscoelastic or energy-absorbing materials may be contemplated, as those discussed above with respect to other embodiments. The upper portion may be made of the same material than the bottom portion, though a different material may be used for the upper portion.

(64) Referring to FIG. **25**, there is shown an inner cavity of the helmet **10** having a number of slippage pads **20** of the type shown in FIGS. **10** to **12**, disposed at selected locations on the inner liner **12** of the helmet **10**. Though the slippage pads **20** of FIGS. **10-12** are shown in FIG. **25**, other embodiments of the slippage pads **20** may also be used as alternatives to the ones of FIGS. **10-12**. There is also shown cushioning pads **15** disposed on the inner liner **12**. The cushioning pads **15** are removably connected to the inner liner **12**, such as, by Velcro™. The cushioning pads **15** may also be connected in other ways or in supplemental ways to the helmet **10** in other embodiments, such

as by adhesive bonding or other means for permanently and/or releasably connecting the cushioning pads **15** to the inner liner **12**. As shown, the cushioning pads **15** may define apertures that correspond in shape and dimensions to the slippage pads **20**, for the slippage pads **20** to be surrounded by the cushioning pads **15**, if desired. In such arrangement, there may or may not be direct connection between the cushioning pads **15** and the slippage pads **20**. Some or all of the slippage pads **20** may be disposed within the apertures of the cushioning pads **15**, though this is optional. The cushioning pads **15** may thus contour at least some of the slippage pads **20**. This may improve comfort of the helmet **10** having such slippage pads **20**, as the cushioning pads **15** and the slippage pads **20** may form a continuous head contacting surface that contacts the wearer's head when the helmet **10** is worn. The cushioning pads **15** may not have such apertures in other embodiments, for instance, where the cushioning pads **15** and the slippage pads **20** are distributed in an alternating sequence of slippage pads **20** and cushioning pads **15**, or otherwise, as discussed above. The helmet **10** may be without cushioning pads **15** altogether.

(65) As shown, the slippage pads **20** are connected to the inner liner **12**. The slippage pads **20** may be connected to the inner liner **12** by adhesive bonding. Other ways to secure the slippage pads **20** to the inner liner **12** may be contemplated in other embodiments, such as co-molding, mechanical interlocking or via mechanical connectors, such as mechanical fasteners. As shown, the slippage pads **20** are directly connected to the inner liner **12**. In other embodiments, the slippage pads **20** may be connected to an intermediary piece of material, such as the web **80** discussed above, or a layer of material such as a layer of woven material, interconnecting the slippage pads **20** together. This may facilitate handling of the slippage pads **20** as a cluster of slippage pads **20** during manufacturing and/or assembly of the helmet **10**, amongst other things.

(66) In an embodiment, the slippage pads **20** have a base portion **Z1** along axis **Z** (FIG. **10**) received in respective recesses **16** defined within the inner liner **12**, with a head contacting portion **Z2** projecting beyond a plane of the inner liner **12**. This is illustrated in a cross-sectional view of a portion of the helmet **10** in FIG. **26**, according to an embodiment. The recesses **16** and the slippage pads **20** may be dimensioned to be in a close fit fashion, which may allow the slippage pads **20** to be “laterally” retained on the inner liner **12**. This may help securing the slippage pads **20** to the inner liner **12** and/or provide a mechanical abutment between the slippage pads **20** and the inner liner **12**, thereby reducing the shear stress in the adhesive bonding that may connect the slippage pads **20** to the inner liner **12**, in embodiments where such adhesive bonding is present, during shear deformation of the slippage pads **20**. In some variants, the recessed **16** may be dimensioned or shaped such that a peripheral space is provided between the recesses lateral walls and a periphery of the slippage pads **20**. This may allow the slippage pads **20** to expand laterally while being compressed until the periphery of the slippage pads **20** abuts against the recess lateral walls.

(67) The slippage pad **20** has the head contacting portion **Z2** that protrudes from the concave inner surface of the inner liner **12**, out from the recess **16**. The recesses **16** may allow the slippage pads **20** to have a greater overall thickness, which may increase the energy absorption of the slippage pads **20**, as opposed to embodiments where the inner liner **12** has no recess **16** receiving the slippage pads **20**. The recesses **16** may thus allow the use of thicker slippage pads **20** while concurrently keeping the helmet **10** “compact”, in that the inner liner **12** may still remain close to the wearer's head when the helmet **10** is worn. This may contribute to having a helmet **10** that appears less bulky on the wearer's head without compromising on the thickness of the slippage pads **20** between the wearer's head and the inner liner **12**. In embodiments where the recesses **16** are present, a ratio of a recess depth over the thickness of the slippage pads **20** is no more than 1:2, (i.e., dimension of **Z1** along axis **Z** over **Z1+Z2**). In some cases, such ratio may be no more than 1:3, and in some cases no more than 1:4. Other ratios are possible in other embodiments.

(68) The dimensions of the slippage pads **20** may be any appropriate dimensions for use in a helmet **10**. In an embodiment, the slippage pads **20** have an elongated shape with a length of 40 mm±20 mm (i.e., along axis **X**), and a width of 13 mm±7 mm (i.e., along axis **Y**). The slippage pads **20**

may have other dimensions. A thickness of the slippage pads **20** may range between 2 mm and 10 mm (i.e., along axis Z). The slippage pads **20** may have other thickness dimensions in other embodiments. As shown, the slippage pads **20** all have the same dimensions and shape. However, this may be different in other embodiments, where at least some or all of the slippage pads **20** may be shaped and/or dimensions differently from one another.

(69) The slippage pads **20** may be made of a composite material including polyurethane (PU) and a non-Newtonian polymeric material, such as the DCLAN™ gel discussed above, the D3O™ material, or another non-Newtonian material. In an embodiment, a density of such slippage pads **20** is $0.27 \text{ g/cm}^3 \pm 0.10 \text{ g/cm}^3$. Other densities may be contemplated in other embodiments. The slippage pads **20** may be formed as an integral monolithic piece of a non-Newtonian polymeric material in other embodiments. Other materials, of non-Newtonian or Newtonian types may be contemplated in other embodiments. For instance, in other embodiments, the slippage pads **20** may be made of a polymeric material, such as silicone, polyethylene (PE), polypropylene (PP), thermoplastic polyurethane (TPU), rubber, with or without the addition of a non-Newtonian polymeric material. As discussed above, the non-Newtonian polymeric material may provide great energy absorption characteristics because of its rheological behaviour when subjected to an impact, as it may harden from a non-rigid state (i.e. a gel state) to form an impact protection layer while absorbing, at least partially, the impact energy. This may provide improved impact energy absorption when subjected to a low density energy impact and/or a high density energy impact, as the non-Newtonian polymer may rheologically respond differently to low impact energy and to high impact energy.

(70) An angled impact on the helmet **10** having such slippage pads **20** may result in geometrical deformation of the tubes **70** relative to the wearer's head. In other words, an angled impact on the helmet **10** may result in a movement resulting from deformation of the tubes **70** and relative movement of the head contacting surface of the slippage pads **20** relative to the inner liner **12**. Some or all of the slippage pads **20** may be subjected to local deformation independently of how the other slippage pads **20** react. The common reaction of the slippage pads **20**, which may correspond to the sum of deformations of the slippage pads **20** disposed at selected locations on the inner liner **12** of the helmet **10**, when an angled impact on the helmet **10** is made, may provide impact energy absorption via geometrical deformation of the slippage pads **20**. As such, the amount of impact energy transmitted to the wearer's head may be less than that transmitted to the wearer's head when the slippage pads **20** are absent from the helmet **10**, in some embodiments. The deformation of the slippage pads **20**, as mentioned previously, may be in the form of flexion, compression, distortion, shearing and/or buckling of the tubes **70**.

(71) The helmet **10** defines a frontal portion for covering at least partially a frontal region of the wearer's head, a rear portion for covering a rear region of the head, opposite lateral portions for covering opposite lateral regions of the head, and a top portion for covering a top region of the head. With continued reference to FIG. 25, a number of slippage pads **20** may be disposed at selected locations within the cavity of the helmet **10**, between the inner liner **12** and the wearer's head when the helmet **10** is worn, to contact respective portions of the wearer's head. As shown, there may be at least two slippage pads **20** in each of the frontal, rear, and top portions of the helmet **10** to locally contact the wearer's head, and at least one slippage pad **20** in each of the opposed lateral portions of the helmet **10**. In an embodiment, such as shown, at least two slippage pads **20** are longitudinally disposed on each side of a sagittal plane X-X of the helmet **10** (FIG. 25), which bisects the inner cavity into opposite inner cavity lateral regions. The slippage pads **20** on each side of the sagittal plane X-X, located respectively in the frontal and top portions of the helmet **10**, may be longitudinally oriented transversally (transversally or in some cases perpendicularly) to a frontal plane Y-Y (FIG. 25) of the helmet **10**, which bisects the inner cavity of the helmet **10** in respective rear and frontal inner cavity regions. That is, the at least two slippage pads **20** may be longitudinally oriented in a front-to-rear direction of the helmet **10**, their respective

longitudinal projections extending between the opposite lateral portions of the helmet **10**. In this disposition, the footprint of the slippage pads **20** may be generally longitudinally aligned with a force vector resulting from an angled impact oriented toward the frontal portion of the helmet **10**. The force vector of the angled impact may have a linear component, which may be generally transverse to the convex outer surface of the helmet **10**, that may induce compression deformation in the slippage pads **20** located in the front portion of the helmet **10**. The force vector of the angled impact may also have a tangential component, which is tangent to the convex outer surface of the helmet **10** and aligned in a front-to-rear direction of the helmet **10**, whereby the slippage pads **20** are induced with shearing deformation along the longitudinal dimension of their footprint. This may provide better friction/adherence of the head contacting surface of the slippage pads **20** with the wearer's head to cause the shearing deformation and/or allow a better transmission of the impact energy from the outer shell **13** to the slippage pads **20** in compression and/or shear to absorb the impact energy, at least partially, for instance.

(72) Additionally, the at least one slippage pad **20** in the opposite lateral portions of the helmet **10** are located on the inner liner **12** at locations that intersect with the frontal plane Y-Y of the helmet **10**. The at least two slippage pads **20** located in the rear portion of the helmet **10** are longitudinally oriented such that their respective longitudinal projections are transverse to the longitudinal projections of the slippage pads **20** of the frontal and top portions of the helmet **10**. The individual position of the slippage pads **20** and their relative positions may be different in other embodiments.

Claims

1. A helmet comprising: at least an inner liner forming a body of the helmet, the inner liner having a concave inner surface defining a cavity configured for receiving a wearer's head; a plurality of slippage pads disposed at selected locations on the concave inner surface and connected to the inner liner, the slippage pads having an elongated shape with a length and a width, the length being greater than the width, the slippage pads having an undersurface and a head contacting surface spaced apart from and opposite to the undersurface, the slippage pads each defining a number of integrally connected side-by-side tubes each having an opening at the head contacting surface adapted to be oriented toward the wearer's head, the openings aligned longitudinally along the length of the slippage pads, the openings opened toward the cavity, and an attachment system to attach the helmet to the wearer's head.
2. The helmet as defined in claim 1, wherein all the slippage pads are shaped and size to be identical to each other.
3. The helmet as defined in claim 1, wherein lateral pairs of the slippage pads are disposed on each side of a sagittal plane of the helmet.
4. The helmet as defined in claim 3, wherein the lateral pairs of the slippage pads are evenly laterally spaced apart from the sagittal plane of the helmet.
5. The helmet as defined in claim 1, wherein a frontal pair of the slippage pads is disposed in a frontal portion of the helmet.
6. The helmet as defined in claim 1, further comprising at least one cushioning pad disposed on the concave inner surface of the inner liner.
7. The helmet as defined in claim 6, wherein the cushioning pad has apertures defined therethrough, the apertures corresponding in shape and dimensions to the slippage pads, wherein some of the slippage pads are disposed within the apertures of the cushioning pad.
8. The helmet as defined in claim 1, wherein recesses are defined within the inner liner, the slippage pads having a base portion received in respective ones of the recesses, the slippage pads having a head contacting portion projecting beyond a surrounding surface of the inner liner.
9. The helmet as defined in claim 8, wherein the recesses and the slippage pads are dimensioned for lateral walls of the slippage pads to contact surfaces of the recesses.

10. The helmet as defined in claim 1, wherein the slippage pads have a length of $40\text{ mm}\pm 20\text{ mm}$, and a width of $13\text{ mm}\pm 7\text{ mm}$.
 11. The helmet as defined in claim 1, wherein a thickness of the slippage pads ranges between 2 mm and 10 mm.
 12. The helmet as defined in claim 1, wherein a density of the slippage pads is $0.27\text{ g/cm}^3\pm 0.10\text{ g/cm}^3$.
 13. The helmet as defined in claim 1, wherein the slippage pads are made of a composite material including polyurethane and a non-Newtonian polymeric material.
 14. The helmet as defined in claim 1, wherein the plurality of tubes is a pair of tubes, the openings of the pair of tubes each having an obround shape.
 15. The helmet as defined in claim 1, wherein the openings have a length of $15\text{ mm}\pm 5\text{ mm}$ and a width of $5\text{ mm}\pm 3\text{ mm}$.
 16. The helmet as defined in claim 1, wherein a ratio of the sum of a length of the openings over the length of the slippage pad is $70\%\pm 20\%$.
 17. The helmet as defined in claim 1, wherein a ratio of a width of the openings over the width of the slippage pad range between 25% and 40%.
 18. The helmet as defined in claim 1, wherein at least a first and a second one of the slippage pads are longitudinally oriented in a front-to-rear direction of the helmet, the at least two slippage pads having a respective longitudinal projection extending between the opposite lateral portions of the helmet.
 19. The helmet according to claim 1, wherein the inner liner is made of expanded polystyrene.
 20. The helmet according to claim 1, wherein the attachment system includes a strap element anchored to the body of the helmet.
 21. The helmet according to claim 1, wherein the slippage pads define blocks of resilient material.
 22. A helmet comprising: at least an inner liner forming a body of the helmet, the inner liner having a concave inner surface defining a cavity configured for receiving a wearer's head; a plurality of slippage pads disposed at selected locations on the concave inner surface and connected to the inner liner, the slippage pads defining blocks of resilient material, the blocks being monoblock pieces made of a single material, the blocks having an elongated shape with a length and a width, the length being greater than the width, the blocks having an undersurface and a head contacting surface on opposite sides of the blocks, the blocks each having a number of integrally connected side-by-side tubes each having an opening defined in the head contacting surface and opened to the cavity, the openings adapted to be oriented toward the wearer's head, the openings aligned longitudinally along the length of the blocks and an attachment system to attach the helmet to the wearer's head.
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